

“I give you my word that what you see on the paper before you is everything I own in the world, and it isn’t much,” Bud said.

“But why don’t you want me to join in the lawsuit, Bud? If this is all you own and our agreement is thrown into the bankruptcy too, you won’t have to repay us either.”

“Because my wife has convinced me that God can show Himself strong through this,” Bud replied with confidence. “My part is to ask my creditors to trust me as I trust the Lord.”

Bud then shared Psalm 50:14–15, a passage he and Sandi believed God had given to them the night they pledged to repay everyone who did not join the bankruptcy action: “Sacrifice thank offerings to God, fulfill your vows to the Most High, and call upon me in the day of trouble; I will deliver you, and you will honor me.”

“Well, Bud, that’s about the strangest proposal I have ever heard in my years as a banker, but I’m a Christian too, so ...” Bud waited as the banker thought. “Tell you what—I’ll take this to my board of directors at our meeting this Thursday. I’ll recommend we go along with you on this, but the final decision is up to the board.”

“I understand, and I sincerely appreciate your confidence in me,” Bud said as he started to leave.

“Bud, I believe you’re an honest man, and you always did a good job for me. You made errors in judgment on some of the land deals we funded, but who hasn’t? You borrowed too much on speculation, but frankly we lent too much on the same projects.”

“Thank you. That really does encourage me. I trust we’ll both see some miracles.”

Later that week Bud heard from the banker that the board had agreed to maintain their notes and not join the bankruptcy.

The bankruptcy proceeded rapidly, with all but three creditors joining in the proceeding. Bud and Sandi did not contest the bankruptcy action and surrendered all of their personal assets voluntarily, including personal jewelry, even their wedding rings. The bankruptcy judge instructed them that they had the right to